Instead of saying a word about stopping the overhaul, Netanyahu lashed out against those reserve officers who will not report for reserve duty. Ben-Gvir stood at his side and added some nonsense of his own. Is this the running amok of desperation or the brazen self-assurance of two hardened hoodlums who believe that they can topple the justice system? As for Herzog, he is possibly full of goodwill, but he also may be either just naive or basking in the limelight during his own fifteen minutes. The only benefit of this whole episode is the proof, once again, of Netanyahu's resolve to get the new judiciary laws through to save his skin, and, mainly, the proof that Lapid and Gantz can stand together.

About a week after the pogrom in Huwara, settlers returned to the town and celebrated Purim with dances. Some soldiers danced with them and that is the real shame. Where are the officers, where is discipline, what is the position of the army command? Will there be any sanctions?

Michael Bloomberg, Jewish former mayor of New York, a billionaire, and a great friend and benefactor of Israel, came out in the *New York Times* with a very strong op-ed piece against the Netanyahu government's policies. In his view, if it pushes on, "Israel is courting disaster."

Ben-Gvir, who cannot stand being out of the news even for an hour, announced that information has reached the police that indicates growing incitement to murder him. When a police spokesman indicated that no such information had reached them, the publicity-crazy minister ordered him to report for a clarification, which means a dressing-down.

## *Tuesday, March 7*

Last night, an operation took place in Jenin. The Palestinian suspected of shooting the two Israeli youths in Huwara was killed, as were five other Palestinians. Nine more were wounded. The vicious circle doesn't stop.